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The Royal Hospital

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Title: Discharge Against Medical Advice/LAMA

1- Definitions

DischargeAgainst Medical Advice - the process of terminating admission orhospitalization on patient's own will against medical advice of the treatingdoctor. Neither the hospital nor the doctor is held liable for anything thatmay happen

2- Purposes

2-1To protect the treating doctor or the hospital for any unexpected lawsuits.

2-2To give advice about patient condition and the need for admission after theadmission procedure is already processed.

3- Policies

- Any patient who refuses admissionshould be advised to fill up and sign the LAMA Form, which is counter signed bythe treating physician and patient's relative.

- In case of discharge (LAMA) PRO should be called if patient has infected disease or life-threatening condition or patient is competent.
- If patient is stable and there is no public health concern, under discretion of senior ER physician; PRO attendance may not be needed.

4- Procedures

4-1 If the patient refuses admission advice.

- The treating physician to document "refused admission - LAMA" in the medical record form.
- Patient must be competent to take full responsibility of consequences (competency to be ascertained by senior physician)
- Patient and/or relative must sign the LAMA Form, and must be counter signed by the treating physician and patient's relative with full name and details. The details of witness and relatives full name to be documented in patient file.
- If patient is not competent as confirmed by treating physician, the relative (first degree) must take the responsibility and this to be communicated to PRO.
- Competency of patient to be established by senior physician.

4-2 If the patient refuses admission after the admission procedure is already processed and a room is allotted.

- The nurse calls & informs the admitting physician.
- The physician to explain to the patient the need for admission.
- The patient /guardian to sign the LAMA form with date and time and full details of relative (full name), same to be documented in patient file.
- The nurse to witness & sign, same to be documented in patient file
- The patient will be given discharge summary or instructions to come back if the clinical status deteriorates.
- The nurse informs the supervisor on duty, admission and discharge office as well as bed management of the discharge.

4-4CompleteDocumentation with record of events.

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